

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 3
 ♥ J 10 8 5
 ♦ 10 6
 ♣ 9 7 6 4

♠ A 10 5

♥ Q 6 3

♦ 8 7 4 2

♣ J 8 5



♠ 8 6

♥ A K 7 2

♦ 9 5 3

♣ Q 10 3 2

♠ Q 9 7 4 2

♥ 9 4

♦ A K Q J

♣ A K

West	North	East	South
------	-------	------	-------

Pass	2♠	Pass	1♠
------	----	------	----

All Pass

4♠ by South
 back toward his ♠Q, playing East for the ♠K. If he plays this way you will get two tricks and defeat the contract.

[showcards S:S4]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♥J, covered by dummy's ♥Q and won by East's ♥K. East wins the ♥A at the second trick and continues with a small ♥ ruffed by South.

South then plays the ♠4 from his hand. Do you play low? or play the ♠J to force dummy's ♠A?

Play the ♠3.

If South decides to finesse the ♠10 then you will still win the one ♠ trick which you are entitled to win.

However, with South holding the ♠Q it would be very logical for him to go up with the ♠A then lead

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 5 3
 ♥ 9 8 7 2
 ♦ 8 6 5 3
 ♣ K 6

♠ K 7 4

♥ A J 10

♦ Q J 4

♣ Q J 10 7

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 6 2

♥ 6 5 3

♦ 9 7 2

♣ 5 4 3

♠ A 10 8

♥ K Q 4

♦ A K 10

♣ A 9 8 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	6NT		2NT
All Pass			
6NT by South			

[showcards N:S4]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥9, taken by dummy's ♥10. The ♠4 is then played from dummy. Do you play low? or split your honors?

Play the ♠J (or ♠Q).

You should always make a point count check as soon as you see dummy. South's 2NT promises 20 or 21 points, North has 14 and you have 3; total = 37 or 38. Therefore West must have either 2 or 3 points. He cannot have two Jacks because you can see all four of them. Likewise he cannot have a Queen because you can see three of them and his ♥ lead (top of nothing) denied that Queen.

It follows that West **MUST** have a King, and it must be ♣s or ♦s since he has denied any ♥ Honor.

Since West will definitely win his King, you need to take one trick yourself, and the best way to do that is to split your Honors to establish one ♠ winner.

South has no defense to this, but if you had played low he would have played the ♠10 and made the slam.